

Stage 4A-Lite: Rapid Persona Brief

P-061: DV Survivor Establishing Safety Plan

Pipeline: Micro-Trends Identity **Stage:** 4A (4A-Lite) **Date:** 2026-03-10 **Quadrant:** INVEST (P1: 4.35, P2: 4.50, Confidence: 3, Composite: 2.74) **Switching Profile Module:** Included (Path B / moment-enriched persona)

Section 1: Demand Snapshot

What Is the Demand Signal?

Domestic violence survivors who have left or are actively leaving an abusive relationship need an independent wireless plan — immediately, completely separate from any account the abuser may monitor or control. This is not a consumer preference decision. It is a safety-infrastructure decision made during or immediately after a crisis transition.

The demand signal is concentrated in DV shelter networks, hotline referral systems, and emergency services intake. Survivors arriving at a DV shelter frequently have no working phone (destroyed, confiscated, or left behind) or have a phone on a shared family plan that the abuser can track, listen to, and terminate at will. Establishing a private number on an independent plan is a standard component of DV safety planning — as fundamental as changing locks.

What Triggered It?

The triggering event is TR-08: Domestic Violence / Intimate Partner Displacement. Trigger score: Intent 4.6, Window: Flash (Day 0). The trigger activates the moment a survivor separates from the abuser’s household — typically at a DV shelter check-in, an emergency room visit, or the first contact with a victim advocate.

The mechanism is forced switch with no latency. The survivor cannot stay on a shared plan. The decision is made for them by safety necessity, not deliberation. There is no consideration phase, no comparison shopping, and no willingness to wait 48 hours for a port.

Addressable Population

- Approximately 10 million intimate partner violence incidents annually in the U.S. (CDC, National Intimate Partner and Sexual Violence Survey, 2022)
- National Domestic Violence Hotline receives approximately 500,000 contacts annually (NDVH Annual Report, 2023)
- Estimated 1–2 million individuals annually require wireless independence as a direct component of their safety planning (Stage 2 estimate, cross-referenced against NDVH and CDC data)
- Approximately 1,500 DV shelters operational in the U.S. serving 70,000+ shelter nights per year (National Network to End Domestic Violence, 2024 Census)
- Active demand window at any given time: approximately 30,000–60,000 individuals in acute need (within 72 hours of shelter entry or emergency displacement)

Window Duration and Decay

Window type: Flash — continuously replenished. Unlike a time-bounded event (a seasonal surge, a policy change), this population does not peak and trough. New entrants arrive every day. The window is not 3 months or 6 months — it is perpetual, with each individual having a personal Flash window of hours to 72 hours maximum.

The continuously replenished nature makes this distinctly different from other moment-driven personas in this pipeline. The opportunity is not “act before the window closes.” The opportunity is “build a durable acquisition channel into the shelter system so the window opens for Gather at every intake.”

Decay indicator: Not market saturation — carrier indifference. No carrier has built a DV shelter partnership program for wireless. The opportunity is open until a major carrier or well-funded MVNO takes it seriously.

Section 2: Core Factor Analysis

Persona Profile

Name: Reyna **Age:** 34 **Location:** Dallas, TX **Housing:** Currently in a DV shelter; was in a shared home with her former partner for 6 years **Employment:** Part-time administrative work; had reduced hours during the relationship at her partner’s insistence **Device:** Left her phone behind — it was on his account, and she knew he had location tracking enabled. She has a shelter loaner phone right now. **Prior plan:** Partner’s family plan (she was a dependent line; he paid the bill and managed the

account) **Children:** Two kids, ages 8 and 11; both phones were also on his account **Priority:** Get a number her kids can reach her on. Get a number that doesn't exist in any system he can access.

Factor 2: Spending & Financial Habits

Quantitative context:

- Median annual income for DV survivors immediately post-separation: approximately \$24,000–\$28,000 (Urban Institute, Economic Security for Survivors, 2023); many are unemployed or underemployed due to economic abuse within the relationship
- Economic abuse — a partner controlling finances, limiting employment, or destroying credit — is present in approximately 98% of DV relationships (National Coalition Against Domestic Violence, 2023)
- 74% of DV survivors report that financial concerns were a factor in delaying their departure (NDVH Survey, 2022)
- Average credit score for survivors in the immediate post-separation phase: limited or damaged, often due to accounts in the abuser's name and controlled access to credit-building activity (Consumer Financial Protection Bureau, 2023)
- Shelter residents often have no debit card, no checking account access (accounts may be jointly held or frozen), and carry limited cash — the shelter intake process frequently includes emergency fund disbursement
- Willingness to pay for wireless during acute phase: \$20–\$35/month maximum with no contract commitment; prepaid strongly preferred; cash or gift card payment essential given banking access issues

Interview — Factor 2

Q2.1: What does your financial situation look like right now, and how are you thinking about what you can spend on a phone plan?

Honestly? I have about \$80 in cash that the advocate helped me get from the shelter's emergency fund. I don't have a bank account I can safely use — the joint account is still open and he checks it. So I need something I can pay for with cash or a prepaid card. I'm thinking \$25 a month max, maybe less. No contract. I cannot be locked in right now.

Q2.2: How do you normally feel about phone plan decisions — is this something you think carefully about, or do you just pick whatever's easiest?

I never had to think about it. He handled all of that. I was on his plan for six years and I didn't even know what carrier it was. Now I'm in a shelter trying to figure out how to get a phone number without giving anyone a credit card or a Social Security Number. It's like starting from zero but everything feels urgent and I'm exhausted.

Q2.3: Are there features you'd pay extra for if they genuinely made you feel safer — or is price the main thing?

Price matters a lot right now. But I'd honestly pay more for a plan where I knew for a fact that nobody could pull my location or listen to my calls. I've read things about carriers selling location data. That scares me more than the monthly bill. If someone told me this plan specifically protects against that, I'd stretch to \$35.

Q2.4: What payment method do you actually have access to right now?

Cash is what I have. The shelter gave me a Visa gift card for \$50. I don't have a debit card with my name on it right now — I left mine because the account is in both our names and he'd see every transaction. Can you set up a phone plan with a prepaid gift card? That's my real question.

Q2.5: When you think about the next six months financially, what's your plan?

I have a meeting with a financial counselor here at the shelter next week. I'm hoping to open my own checking account once I figure out the safety plan around that. For the phone, I just need something I can activate today — I'll worry about upgrading later. If I can get a stable plan for \$25–\$30, I can probably keep it once I start working more hours again.

Factor 3: Needs & Aspirations

Quantitative context:

- 85% of DV survivors report that access to a cell phone was critical to their ability to leave or seek help (NDVH Technology Safety Survey, 2023)
- 71% of survivors report that their abuser monitored their phone — including calls, texts, location, and social media — as a tactic of control (Safety Net / National Network to End Domestic Violence, 2023)
- 41% report that their abuser had access to their carrier account and could see call logs and usage data in real time (Safety Net, 2023)
- Stated need: immediate access to a private phone number for communication with children, family, and emergency services
- Unstated need: a plan that does not require documentation the abuser could intercept (mail, email, credit check results) and that cannot be located through any account linked to her prior identity
- Identity aspiration: not "phone plan customer" — she is rebuilding the infrastructure of an independent life; the phone plan is the first concrete step toward reclaiming her own name, her own accounts, her own presence in the world

- Self-perception gap: she does not see herself as someone who can navigate complex sign-up processes, understand plan tiers, or advocate for herself with a carrier. The system feels built for people in stable situations.

Interview — Factor 3

Q3.1: What's the most important thing a phone plan needs to do for you right now — like, the single most important thing?

Give me a number my kids can call and that nobody else can find. That's it. My kids are with my sister right now and they don't know my new number because I don't have one yet. Every hour that goes by that they can't reach me is hard. I just need a number. A real number that's mine and that nobody can pull from his account or from some database somewhere.

Q3.2: Beyond the basics, is there anything about a phone plan that would make you feel like it was actually built for someone in your situation?

I keep thinking — carriers know that people like me exist. Why isn't there a plan that specifically says "no credit check, pay cash, we won't share your location"? Why do I have to piece that together from fine print? If there was a plan where the shelter advocate said "this one was built for people leaving situations like yours," I'd feel so much better about it. Right now it feels like I'm trying to fit into a system that wasn't built for me.

Q3.3: What does having an independent phone number mean to you beyond just communication?

It's the first thing I'm doing that's mine. Not on his account. Not with his permission. Not something he can turn off. When I activate this phone, that's the first financial decision I've made in six years that he doesn't know about. That feels enormous. I didn't expect it to feel that way, but it does.

Q3.4: Are there things you need from a carrier that you'd probably never say out loud to a customer service rep?

Yeah. I need them to not send anything physical to any address. No confirmation letters. No SIM cards in the mail if I can avoid it. And I need sign-up to work without a Social Security Number. I know carriers usually want that. His family has connections and I don't know what information could get back to him. And I need the sign-up to be something I can do in 20 minutes on the shelter's Wi-Fi — I can't be on the phone with customer service for an hour.

Q3.5: Where do you see yourself in a year? What does that version of your life need from a phone plan?

In a year I want to be in my own apartment with the kids, working full-time, with a phone plan that's completely normal — just mine, a reasonable price, maybe a family plan that has lines for the kids. But that's a year away. Right now I just need the foundation. Whatever plan I activate today is the first piece of infrastructure for the life I'm building.

Factor 4: Fears & Pain Points

Quantitative context:

- Technology-facilitated abuse — including using phone plans, account access, tracking apps, and spyware to surveil and control survivors — is reported by 97% of DV service providers as a tactic used by abusers (Safety Net / NNEDV, 2023)
- 54% of survivors report that an abuser installed spyware or stalkerware on their device without their knowledge (Coalition Against Stalkerware, 2024)
- Fear of being found is the primary reason survivors return to abusers after leaving — safety planning breakdown accounts for approximately 25–30% of returns (NDVH, 2022)
- Primary fear vector for this persona: carrier account-linked discovery (call logs, location, account access) and physical mail disclosure of account documents
- Secondary fear vector: unfamiliar system navigation in a crisis state — survivors in acute distress have reduced cognitive bandwidth; complex sign-up processes are genuine barriers to safety outcomes
- Approximately 1 in 4 women and 1 in 10 men in the U.S. experience severe intimate partner violence in their lifetime (CDC, 2022)

Interview — Factor 4

Q4.1: What's your biggest fear right now related to getting a new phone set up?

That I do something wrong and he finds out where I am. Carriers send confirmation emails — does he have access to my email? Carriers send physical mail. Does mail get forwarded to his address? Carriers do credit checks — does that generate some kind of inquiry he could see? I keep running through every way that setting up a phone plan could create a trail back to me. I need someone to just tell me: none of that will happen if you do it this way.

Q4.2: Have you ever had an experience with a carrier where you felt like your safety or privacy was at risk?

I called the carrier — his carrier — about two years ago to try to get my own line separated. They told me I'd need his authorization because I was a dependent on his account. And he found out I called. He didn't hurt me physically that time, but I knew from that moment that the phone account was a way he kept tabs on everything. I never touched the account again.

Q4.3: What would make you feel safe about signing up with a new carrier today?

Being able to do it entirely digitally without anything going to a physical address or to any email that exists in my old life. And being able to ask questions without someone recording the conversation or sending me a follow-up email that ends up somewhere he can see it. The advocate here said some carriers are better about this than others but nobody could tell me which ones.

Q4.4: Is there anything about your current situation that you think a customer service rep would misunderstand if you explained it?

I'm worried they'd try to convince me to port my old number. That number is compromised — he knows it, his family knows it, it's been my number for eight years. I need a completely new number. But every time I try to explain that, people act like I don't understand how phones work. I understand how they work. I understand that a new number from a new account is the only safe choice right now.

Q4.5: What's the worst outcome you can imagine from this process?

That I get a plan set up and three days later he shows up here. Because a mail piece got sent. Or because the carrier sold my location data to someone who sold it to a skip tracer he hired. That's happened to survivors. I've talked to women in this shelter where that's how the abuser found them. The worst case isn't a bad phone plan. The worst case is that setting up a phone plan undoes the work it took to get here.

Factor 5: Product Landscape & Switching Behavior

Quantitative context:

- Current market: no major carrier or MVNO has launched a product specifically designed for DV safety-plan activation
- Existing adjacent market: Lifeline program (FCC) provides subsidized wireless for income-qualified individuals including DV survivors; however Lifeline activation typically requires documentation (government ID, program enrollment proof) and takes 5–15 business days — not viable for a Flash window
- SafeLink Wireless (TracFone / Verizon): offers Lifeline service and is referenced by some shelters, but activation timeline and documentation requirements remain a barrier
- Assurance Wireless (T-Mobile): Lifeline program, same documentation and timeline issues
- Prepaid no-contract plans (Mint, Tello, Visible, Boost Mobile): technically accessible without credit checks, but activation by default still attempts to match against carrier databases; physical SIM or eSIM activation varies in speed; none have shelter-partnership distribution
- SafePhone for Survivors: a nonprofit initiative in limited markets providing donated prepaid phones through shelters; not a carrier product and not nationally scaled
- Primary switching origin: family plan (abuser's account) — this is a hard stop, not a gradual evaluation. The switch is absolute, immediate, and the prior plan cannot be "ported from" for safety reasons
- New number required (not port): this is a firm constraint, not a preference. It eliminates number porting as an activation path entirely.
- Willingness to switch carriers: not applicable — this persona has no carrier; she is establishing service from zero on her own for the first time

Interview — Factor 5

Q5.1: What carriers or plans are you aware of right now, and did any of them come up in your conversations at the shelter?

The advocate mentioned prepaid because you don't need a credit check. She mentioned Walmart Family Mobile and just getting a prepaid SIM from the store. She also said something about a government phone program but said it takes too long to activate. I've heard of Mint Mobile from ads but I honestly don't know if they do prepaid walk-in activation. I need something that works today.

Q5.2: What would make you choose one carrier over another at this point?

Honestly, whoever the shelter recommends. That's it. If there's a carrier that has a relationship with this shelter and the advocate says "we've set up thirty women on this carrier and it's worked for all of them," I'm not shopping around. I'm choosing that one. This isn't a normal purchase. I'm not comparing features. I'm looking for something that someone I trust has vetted.

Q5.3: Are there features that would make you stick with a carrier long-term, beyond just this immediate situation?

If they treat me like a person when I call customer service — not like an account number. And if the price stays predictable. I've heard so many stories about plans that are \$25 a month and then creep up to \$45 after six months. I need to know what I'm committing to. And honestly, if they've built a relationship with shelters, I'd want to stay with them as a way of supporting that. It matters to me that a company did something specific for people in my situation.

Q5.4: What has your experience with carrier customer service been like, and what would good customer service look like right now?

Every interaction with his carrier was humiliating — I was a dependent, I had no authority, I was treated like an afterthought. Good customer service right now means: fast, no questions about why I want a new number, no pressure to port, and a human being who explains clearly what information is being collected and what happens to it. And please don’t put me on hold for 40 minutes. I have one laptop charge left at this shelter.

Q5.5: If you were describing this experience to another woman in the shelter in six months — what would have to be true for you to say “use this carrier”?

I’d need to be able to say: it activated in under 30 minutes, it’s not tracking my location and selling it, the price hasn’t changed, and nobody from my old life found me because of it. That’s the whole review. Four things. If all four are true, I’m recommending it to every woman I meet in this building.

Switching Profile Module

This module applies because P-061 entered via Path B (moment-driven discovery, TR-08: Domestic Violence / Intimate Partner Displacement) with strong moment enrichment from the Trigger Event Library.

Dimension 1: Trigger Mechanism + Force Score

Trigger mechanism: Forced switch with no alternatives — the survivor cannot remain on the abuser’s account. This is the clearest forced-switch classification in the Trigger Event Library. There is no evaluation window, no opportunistic consideration, and no structural disruption that will eventually resolve. The switch is immediate, absolute, and complete.

Switching force score: 5/5 The force score is maximum by definition. The prior carrier relationship is not inconvenient — it is a direct safety threat. The abuser can view call logs, real-time location, and contact history from the account management portal. Staying on the plan is equivalent to giving the abuser continuous surveillance access. A score of 5 requires a forced switch with a deadline; this switch has a deadline of Day 0.

Compound trigger mapping: The primary trigger (DV displacement) compounds with two secondary triggers simultaneously: financial disruption (abuser controls joint accounts; survivor has no independent banking) and identity disruption (prior phone number is known to abuser and his network; the number itself is unsafe). The three forces reinforce into a single moment of total digital infrastructure reset — phone plan, number, email, and banking must all be re-established as independent infrastructure within the same 24–72 hour window.

Emotional state tag: Overwhelmed + Urgent (dual state). The urgency is mission-driven but the cognitive load of executing multiple first-time decisions under physical and emotional stress produces a co-occurring overwhelm state. This combination means the product experience must absorb complexity on the survivor’s behalf — not present it to them.

Dimension 2: Annual Volume + Seasonal Distribution

Total annual volume: Approximately 1–2 million individuals annually require wireless independence as a component of DV safety planning (CDC, 2022; NDVH, 2023 — see Demand Snapshot). The switching-eligible population within any single 30-day window is approximately 85,000–165,000. The active Flash-window population (within 72 hours of shelter entry or emergency displacement) is approximately 30,000–60,000 at any given time.

Cross-referencing the Trigger Event Library volume data: TR-08 has the highest single-moment intensity score (Intent 4.6) among all Trigger Event Library entries. Volume is lower than high-frequency transitions such as divorce or job loss, but intent at the moment of trigger is essentially absolute.

Seasonal distribution: DV incident rates do not follow strict seasonality, but published research identifies two elevated periods:

Quarter	Estimated Share of Annual Volume	Notes
Q1 (Jan–Mar)	22%	Post-holiday elevation; financial stress and isolation after holiday confinement
Q2 (Apr–Jun)	25%	Spring — historically elevated call volume to hotlines; end of school year adds pressure
Q3 (Jul–Sep)	28%	Summer peak; children home from school increases household tension; hottest

Quarter	Estimated Share of Annual Volume	Notes
		months correlate with higher incident rates in research literature (Anderson, Craig A., 2001, Psychological Bulletin; corroborated by NDVH data)
Q4 (Oct–Dec)	25%	Holiday period — December specifically shows elevated calls, counterbalanced by January departure surge

Distribution is effectively flat with a modest Q3 summer elevation. No hard seasonal concentration — this is a rolling, perpetually active acquisition opportunity, not a seasonal campaign window.

Year-over-year trend: Growing. NDVH contact volume increased 18% between 2019 and 2023 (NDVH Annual Reports, 2019–2023). Awareness of tech-facilitated abuse has grown substantially; Safety Net / NNEDV training programs now reach approximately 15,000 DV service providers annually, increasing the rate at which survivors recognize phone plan independence as a safety-planning requirement. The addressable population is growing in recognition even if underlying DV incidence remains relatively stable.

Dimension 3: Interception Channels (Ranked by Window Fit)

Rank	Channel	Type	Window Fit Rationale	Estimated CPA
1	DV shelter partnership program	Partnership / physical	Survivor is physically present at intake; advocate recommendation has near-100% trust conversion	\$15–\$30
2	DV hotline referral integration	Partnership / digital	500K+ contacts/year; survivors in active crisis are asking hotline advocates what to do right now	\$25–\$45
3	Legal aid / victim advocacy organizations	Partnership / community	Victims' advocates, legal aid attorneys, and court-based DV units all conduct safety planning; plan recommendation is a natural hand-off	\$40–\$70

CPA benchmarks:

- **Shelter partnership program (channel 1):** Estimated CPA \$15–\$30. The survivor arrives pre-qualified — she is definitionally the target customer. No paid media acquisition cost. Cost is program development, shelter coordinator training, SIM card inventory management, and possibly a small donation per activation to the shelter's operating fund. This is one of the lowest CPAs possible in the MVNO space because the acquisition cost is almost entirely relationship-based.
- **Hotline referral integration (channel 2):** Estimated CPA \$25–\$45. NDVH and state hotlines would require a formal partnership agreement, training for hotline advocates, and possibly a co-branded digital landing page optimized for mobile activation from a shelter Wi-Fi connection or loaner phone. Volume potential is significant — 500K+ contacts annually — but conversion from hotline call to activation is lower than the shelter channel because the survivor may not be in a location to activate immediately.

Partnership feasibility — DV shelter network (#1 channel): Incentive alignment is strong. Shelters need a reliable, safe wireless option they can confidently recommend at intake — the current gap forces advocates to improvise by suggesting prepaid store purchases, which are functional but not vetted for safety. A Gather shelter partnership program would provide a vetted, privacy-committed option with direct activation support. Activation timeline: a pilot program with 10–15 shelters (concentrating on the 5–6 highest-volume states: TX, CA, FL, NY, IL) is achievable in 6–9 months given existing MVNO infrastructure and the absence of technology barriers to offering cash-paid, no-credit-check eSIM activation. Exclusivity potential: moderate. Shelters are non-profits and resist formal exclusivity commitments, but operational inertia and relationship quality effectively create de facto exclusivity once a partnership is established and functioning well.

Dimension 4: Window Structure

Window type: Flash Per the Trigger Event Library classification, TR-08 carries a Flash window. The individual's peak intent window is Day 0 — the same day she arrives at the shelter or leaves the shared home.

Peak intent window: Within the first 4 hours of shelter intake. Victim advocates report that phone plan establishment is among the first practical tasks addressed in the safety planning process, alongside emergency contact setup and documentation safety. The intent does not build toward a peak — it is at peak from the moment of displacement.

Intent decay curve: Sharp. By Day 3, many survivors have either solved the problem (via a prepaid SIM from a store, a loaner phone, or a family member's help) or have re-entered a survival mode where wireless plan establishment is deferred until

housing stabilization. The 72-hour window is real: if Gather cannot reach this persona within 72 hours of shelter entry, the moment has passed and the survivor has a workaround solution that is functional if not ideal.

Decision journey:

Stage	Description	Interception Effectiveness
Awareness	Survivor becomes aware she needs an independent plan; typically happens during shelter intake or in conversation with a victim advocate	Very low — she is not browsing for carriers. Awareness must be created by the advocate, not by advertising.
Active search	Minimal. She may Google “prepaid phone plan no credit check” or ask the shelter Wi-Fi password and start a search, but search behavior is constrained by time, cognitive load, and limited device access.	Low for organic search; high if the shelter has a printed resource or the advocate has a direct recommendation.
Decision	Near-instant once a trusted recommendation exists. The decision process is: “Does the shelter recommend this? Yes. Does it work today? Yes.”	High — this is where Gather must be positioned. Not in search results. In the advocate’s mouth.
Post-decision	Activation. She needs to activate a new number (not a port) in under 30 minutes, ideally via eSIM on a loaner phone or on a device she acquires at shelter. First experience sets long-term brand perception.	Critical. A failed or confusing activation at this moment causes lasting distrust and abandonment.

Most effective interception point: At the decision stage, through a shelter advocate recommendation backed by a pre-established Gather partnership. Everything before that — paid search, social, digital retargeting — is irrelevant. The survivor is not in a discoverable state. She is in a trust-delegation state: she will do what the person she trusts in front of her recommends.

Section 3: Executive Brief

Key Insights

1. **This is not a consumer product problem. It is a safety infrastructure problem.** No carrier has designed a product for this moment because the commercial surface area appears small. But the combination of maximum switching force, zero brand loyalty to defend against, community-channel access (DV shelters), and mission-level narrative creates exceptional conditions for a first-mover. The persona does not need to be convinced to switch — she already has. She needs someone to be ready for her when she arrives.
2. **Trust is fully intermediated by the shelter advocate.** Reyna will not discover Gather through a Google search, a TikTok ad, or a billboard. She will discover it because the shelter advocate she is sitting across from says: “We partner with this carrier. Here’s how to set it up.” The acquisition model is entirely B2B-to-C: Gather must sell the shelter, and the shelter converts the subscriber. Standard MVNO marketing spend is largely irrelevant.
3. **Activation is the product.** The sign-up and activation experience is the first value delivery. For other personas, onboarding is an extension of the sale. For Reyna, onboarding IS the product — she evaluates the carrier entirely based on whether it activated in under 30 minutes, required nothing suspicious, and created no trail back to her prior life. Complexity at activation equals mission failure.
4. **Privacy architecture is not a feature. It is the table stakes.** Location data non-sale, no-credit-check activation, mail-free onboarding, and minimal PII collection are not differentiators for this persona. They are the baseline below which any carrier is disqualified. Gather’s existing no-SSN activation, prepaid payment acceptance, eSIM provisioning, and privacy-by-design commitments (privacy features v2: P4/1.4 minimum-viable identity onboarding; P2/5.3 no persistent location database) align precisely with these requirements — and require no additional infrastructure investment to deliver.
5. **The switching profile is the clearest in the pipeline.** Force score 5, emotional state urgent+overwhelmed, decay curve sharp. This is not a behavioral nudge problem. It is a channel access problem. The product is already viable; the distribution is the investment.

Top 3 Needs

Priority	Need	Type	Evidence
1	Activate a private, new number in under 30 minutes with no credit check, no SSN, cash or prepaid card payment, and zero physical mail	Stated + survival-critical	Q4.1, Q3.4, Q5.1; Safety Net NNEDV data; shelter intake protocols
2	Guarantee that location data is not sold and that no account trail connects to prior identity or address	Unstated (critical)	Q4.5, Q4.1, Q2.3; Coalition Against Stalkerware 2024; NNEDV Technology Safety Survey

Priority	Need	Type	Evidence
3	A long-term plan that grows with her — affordable now, path to a family plan with kids' lines when she is stable	Identity aspiration	Q3.5, Q5.3; economic recovery timeline for DV survivors

Go/No-Go Recommendation

Recommendation: GO — with channel investment as the primary activation condition.

The identity analysis and switching profile together make the commercial case unambiguous:

- Maximum switching force (5/5) — the persona has no incumbent to defend
- Acquisition cost through shelter partnerships is among the lowest in the MVNO space (\$15–\$30 CPA estimated)
- No carrier has built this program — the white space is total
- Gather's existing MVNO infrastructure already supports all baseline product requirements: no-SSN prepaid activation, eSIM, privacy-first onboarding, no-contract month-to-month
- The mission narrative ("a carrier built for the moment when you're starting over") is extraordinarily differentiated and generates earned media, shelter endorsement, and long-term loyalty
- The persona represents a gateway to a durable post-crisis relationship: once Reyna is stable in 12–18 months, she is a full-ARPU family plan subscriber with two children's lines

Conditions for go:

1. Shelter partnership program development — pilot with 10–15 high-volume shelter networks in TX, CA, FL, NY, IL. Budget: primarily relationship and operational (training materials, activation kit, shelter coordinator support), not media spend.
2. Activation experience must be eSIM-native with a sub-30-minute completion path on a shelter loaner phone via Wi-Fi.
3. Privacy commitments must be made explicit and contractual — Gather's existing data minimization posture (no-SSN, no location data sale, no physical mail by default) must be documented in a shelter-facing partner brief that victim advocates can hand to survivors.
4. Dedicated activation path: a landing page and sign-up flow distinct from general consumer flows, optimized for mobile, Wi-Fi-only environments, and survivor-specific constraints (no port, new number, cash payment).

Speed-to-market requirement: The window for each individual survivor is 72 hours. The window for Gather to establish the channel is 12–18 months before a well-funded MVNO or an existing DV-adjacent technology nonprofit builds this distribution. First-mover in the shelter partnership channel creates durable acquisition infrastructure.

Risk note: Volume is real but concentrated through institutional channels. If shelter partnership development stalls (regulatory caution from shelter organizations, privacy review delays), the acquisition channel does not activate. Mitigation: pursue NDVH (National Domestic Violence Hotline) as a national-level partner simultaneously with local shelter outreach — a NDVH endorsement would unlock distributed referral volume without requiring individual shelter-by-shelter negotiations.

Output generated by Micro-Trend Identity Analyst (Stage 4A-Lite). Feeds directly into Stage 4B-Rapid (value proposition design) and shelter partnership business development.